

PEGASUS IS SPYWARE

Pegasus is spyware developed by the israel cyber arms company nso group that is designed to be covertly and remotely installed on mobile phones running ios and android while nso group markets pegasus as a product for fighting crime and terrorism, governments around the world have routinely used the spyware to surveil journalists lawyers political dissidents and human rights activists the sale of pegasus licenses to foreign governments must be approved by israeli ministry of defense

As of march 2023 pegasus operators were able to remotely install the spyware on ios versions through 16.0.3 using a zero click exploit while the capabilities of pegasus may vary over time due to software updates pegasus is generally capable of reading text messages call recording collecting passwords location tracking accessing the target devices microphone and camera and harvesting information from apps the spyware is named after pegasus the winged horse of greek mythology

Cyber watchdog citizen lab and lookout security published the first public technical analyses of pegasus in august 2016 after they captured the spyware in a failed attempt to spy on the iphone of a human rights activist subsequent investigations into pegasus the pegasus project investigation which centered on a leaked list of 50,000 phone numbers reportedly selected for targeting by pegasus customers

NSO Group developed its first iteration of Pegasus spyware in 2011 The company states that it provides authorized governments with technology that helps them combat terror and crime NSO Group has published sections of contracts which require customers to use its products only for criminal and national security investigations and has stated that it has an industry-leading approach to human rights